IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE D

THE PROPOSAL: Measure D asks the voters whether the City of Fortuna should authorize an additional three-quarters of one percent (¾-cent) transactions and use tax, commonly known as a "sales tax," beginning April 1, 2027. The City currently imposes a separate ¾-cent transactions and use tax that is scheduled to expire on March 31, 2033. If Measure D is approved, the combined City transactions and use tax rate will be 1.5% from April 1, 2027, through March 31, 2033.

HOW IT GOT HERE: Fortuna voters approved the existing ¾-cent tax as Measure E in 2016. In 2020, voters approved Measure G, which extended that tax through March 31, 2033. The City Council placed Measure D on the ballot to authorize an additional ¾-cent transactions and use tax.

HOW IT WORKS: Beginning April 1, 2027, the additional ¾-cent tax would apply to taxable retail sales within the City, with a corresponding use tax on taxable tangible personal property stored, used, or otherwise consumed in the City. The tax would be administered by the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration.
The existing ¾-cent tax remains scheduled to expire on March 31, 2033. The additional ¾-cent tax authorized by Measure D would continue after that date unless repealed by the voters or reduced or repealed by the City Council to the extent permitted by law.

HOW THE REVENUE MAY BE USED: Measure D is a general tax. Revenue generated by the measure may be used for any legitimate City governmental purpose, including public safety, police staffing, street and pothole repair, programs for seniors and youth, and park maintenance. The measure is estimated to generate approximately $1.8 million annually. Revenues are subject to independent audit and community oversight.

A "Yes" vote is a vote to approve the additional ¾-cent transactions and use tax.

A "No" vote is a vote against the additional ¾-cent transactions and use tax.

Measure D requires approval by a majority of the voters voting on the measure.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure D. If you desire a copy of the ordinance or measure, please call the elections official's office at 707-445-7481 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

You may also access the full text of the measure on the county website at the following website address (www.humboldtgov.org/elections).

Argument in Favor of Measure D

Vote YES on Measure D to Invest in Fortuna’s Future

Fortuna is a community that takes pride in its quality of life, safe neighborhoods, local businesses, and public services. Measure D will help ensure that these community priorities remain strong for years to come.

Over the past year, the City has listened to residents and businesses through community listening sessions and outreach efforts. The feedback received helped shape a new Strategic Plan focused on the priorities identified by our community, including economic vitality, public services, infrastructure, and long-term fiscal sustainability. We listened, and we are taking action.

The City and community partners have already begun implementing these priorities. Efforts are underway to strengthen Fortuna's economy through a community-led working group, a new economic vision and brand and downtown revitalization planning. These are meaningful steps designed to support local businesses, attract investment, and build a stronger future for Fortuna.

Measure D is a ¾-cent sales tax and is expected to generate approximately $1.8 million annually that may be used for essential City services such as public safety, police staffing, street and pothole repairs, programs for seniors and youth, and park maintenance. Revenues remain local, are independently audited, and cannot be taken by Sacramento for state purposes.

Measure D is more than a funding measure. It is an investment in the future we have been planning together. By providing a stable local funding source, Measure D will help the City continue implementing community priorities, maintaining essential services, and supporting a strong local economy.

Join us in investing in Fortuna's future.

Vote YES on Measure D.

/s/ Mike Johnson, Mayor of Fortuna